EXEMPT FROM REVIEW

No investigator is authorized to determine that one's research project is exempt from review

- protocols that do not involve human participants and identifiable human tissue, biological samples, and data
- no greater than minimal risk or harm to subjects
- Source: 2017 National Ethical Guidelines for Health and Health-related Research (NEGHHR, s. 2017)

RESEARCHER(S)/ PROPONENT(S)

- submits required documents for ethics review

01

02

REC STAFF
(within 2 calendar days)

- checks the completeness of submitted protocol
- issues an acknowledgment receipt for complete submission
- returns to researcher incomplete application
- codes the protocol
- enters the protocol details into the logbook and database
- forwards the encrypted protocol to the REC Chair

03

REC CHAIR / DESIGNATED REC MEMBER
(within 2 calendar days)

- determines whether the protocol qualifies for exemption from review based on:
  - The 2017 National Ethical Guidelines for Health and Health-Related Research
  - CFR 46.101(b) Categories of Exempt Human Subjects Research

REC CHAIR

- signs the decision letter informing the researcher(s)/proponent(s) about the exemption from review

04

REC STAFF
(within 5 calendar days)

- prepares the report on the protocol exempted from review
- communicates the decision to the researcher(s)/ proponent(s)
- include the decision to grant exemption in the agenda of the next regular meeting
- enters into the Logbook of Communications
- files the documents in the protocol file

05

RESEARCHER(S)/ PROPONENT(S)

PROCEED WITH THE RESEARCH

EXPEDITED REVIEW

No longer than 28 calendar days from receipt of a complete set of documents.

This type of review is done for protocols that:

- do not entail greater than minimal risk to study participants,
- do not have study participants belonging to a vulnerable group, and
- do not generate vulnerability

RESEARCHER(S)/ PROPONENT(S)

- submits required documents for ethics review

01

02

REC STAFF
(within 2 calendar days)

- checks the completeness of submitted protocol
- issues an acknowledgment receipt for complete submission
- returns to the researcher incomplete application
- codes the protocol
- enters the protocol details into the logbook and database
- forwards the encrypted protocol to the REC Chair

03

REC CHAIR
(within 2 calendar days)

- determines the type of review or action
- designates 2 reviewers/ Independent Consultant (IC)
- forwards the details of the type of review to the REC Staff
- forwards to reviewers/IC instructions for review and the encrypted electronic copy of the protocol information package

04

PRIMARY REVIEWERS/IC
(within 48 hours)

- acknowledges receipt of the endorsed encrypted protocol

(within 14 calendar days)

- fills up the following:
  - Protocol Review Assessment Form
  - Informed Consent Form Checklist
  - Summary of Reviewer's Comments
  - Summary of Actions Taken
- submits evaluation results with the recommended action to the REC Chair via email and cc REC staff

05

REC CHAIR
(within 3 calendar days)

- reviews the evaluation results and recommended actions
- finalizes the review and the decision on the protocol
- informs the REC Staff of the final decision
- instructs the REC Staff to communicate the final decision to the researcher(s)/ proponent(s)

06

REC STAFF
(within 5 calendar days)

- prepares all the necessary decision documents for release to the proponents/ researchers including the Certificate of Approval, when applicable
- records into the Logbook of Communications the release of said documents
- communicates the review results to the proponents/researchers

07

RESEARCHER(S)/ PROPONENT(S)

If not approved:

- acknowledges receipt of decision letter, Summary of Reviewers' Comment and Actions Taken

REVISE PROTOCOL BASED ON REC RECOMMENDATIONS

If approved:

- conformes the Certificate of Approval

PROCEED WITH THE RESEARCH

08

REC STAFF

- files the documents in the protocol file
- includes the decision of the Review in the Agenda of the next regular meeting

FULL REVIEW

No longer than 7 weeks from receipt of a complete set of documents.
Only protocols submitted with complete documents at least 14 calendar days prior to the scheduled regular meeting shall be included in the ongoing review cycle

This type of review is done for protocols that:

- entail greater than minimal risk to study participants,
- study participants belong to vulnerable group(s), and
- generate vulnerability to participants

RESEARCHER(S)/ PROPONENT(S)
- submits required documents for ethics review

01

02

REC STAFF
(within 2 calendar days)
- checks the completeness of submitted protocol
- issues an acknowledgment receipt for complete submission
- returns to the researcher incomplete application
- codes the protocol
- enters the protocol details into the logbook and database
- forwards the encrypted protocol to the REC Chair

REC CHAIR
(within 2 calendar days)
- determines the type of review or action
- designates 2 reviewers/ Independent Consultant (IC)
- forwards the details of the type of review to the REC Staff
- forwards to reviewers/IC the instructions for review and the encrypted electronic copy of the protocol information package
- forwards to the rest of the committee members the encrypted electronic copy of the protocol information package

03

04

REC MEMBERS/IC
(within 48 hours)
- acknowledges receipt of the endorsed encrypted protocol

PRIMARY REVIEWERS/IC
(within 14 calendar days)
- fills up the following:
  - Protocol Review Assessment Form
  - Informed Consent Form Checklist
  - Summary of Reviewer's Comments
  - Summary of Actions Taken

REC REGULAR MEETING
(2nd Friday of the month)

PRIMARY REVIEWERS/IC
- presents the review findings and recommendations for discussion during the regular meeting
- documents the discussion

REC MEMBERS
- participate actively in the deliberation
- evaluate the research protocol based on review guidelines

REC CHAIR
- summarizes the issues and points to generate a consensus on the final decision

REC STAFF
- records the consensus

05

06

PRIMARY REVIEWERS/IC
(within 2 calendar days)
- finalizes the findings and recommendations in the Summary of Reviewer's Comments and Summary of Actions Taken
- forwards the collated reviews to the Member Secretary

07

MEMBER SECRETARY
(3 calendar days from the date of receipt)
- reviews contents of the Summary of Reviewers' Comment and Actions Taken
- forwards the reviewed Summary of Reviewers' Comment and Actions Taken to the REC Chair

08

REC CHAIR
(within 3 calendar days)
- finalizes the decision about the protocol
- informs the REC Staff of the final decision
- instructs the REC Staff to communicate the final decision to the researcher(s)/ proponent(s)

09

REC STAFF
(within 3 calendar days from finalization of decision)
- prepares all the necessary decision documents for release to the proponents/ researchers including the Certificate of Approval, when applicable
- records into the Logbook of Communications the release of said documents
- communicates the review results to the proponents/researchers

10

RESEARCHER(S)/ PROPONENT(S)

If not approved:
- acknowledges receipt of decision letter, Summary of Reviewers' Comment and Actions Taken

REVISE PROTOCOL BASED ON REC RECOMMENDATIONS

If approved:
- conformes the Certificate of Approval

PROCEED WITH THE RESEARCH

11

REC STAFF
- files the documents in the protocol file